

Iluvatar (9903.HK): China AI Tour: China AI spending and product mix upgrade to drive growth ahead; Buy

We hosted Iluvatar's management on Sep 8 in Shanghai during our China AI Tour.

Management remains positive on AI spending in China and aims for continuous AI chips specification upgrades to capture the growing demand. We remain positive on Iluvatar's strong shipment growth ahead and its product mix upgrade towards next-generation products, although the tight supply of key components could cap the company's shipments and profitability. Key drivers for Iluvatar includes: (1) China's AI capex upcycle, (2) a growing local AI ecosystem, including AI chips, servers, networking, foundation models, and AI applications, (3) a product mix upgrade towards AI chips with stronger computing performance and higher ASP, and (4) client base expansion towards local CSPs. Maintain Buy.

Key takeaways: Management is positive on AI spending in China, and mentioned that Iluvatar is promoting the product mix upgrade towards next-generation AI computing boards, along with related supernode products, which carry stronger computing power and higher ASP. Regarding raw material supplies, management sees the short supply of memory in the market and is collaborating with upstream suppliers to secure inventory and ensure next-generation product delivery. Management believes the capacity ramp-up and technology migration of local memory players could ease the supply tightness in coming years, reflecting the company's positive view on the development of local AI and semiconductor ecosystems. As computing power demand increases in local market, major customers would rely more on technology leaders that can ensure the hardware and software performance and computing power efficiency, which could benefit leading AI chip suppliers, such as Iluvatar.

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Price Target Risks and Methodology – Iluvatar

Valuation: Our 12-month target price of HK\$859 is based on 19.5x 2030E EV / EBITDA, discounted back to 2027E at a COE of 12.7%. Our target EV / EBITDA multiple is derived from the peers' forward EV / EBITDA vs. EBITDA YoY correlation.

Key downside risks: Lower-than-expected AI chip demand in the China market; fiercer-than-expected market competition; slower-than-expected product migration.

9903.HK	12m Price Target: HK\$859.00	Price: HK\$311.60	Upside: 175.7%
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Buy		GS Forecast			
		12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Market cap: HK\$75.3bn / \$9.6bn	Revenue (Rmb mn)	1,033.6	2,884.2	9,505.9	17,346.3
Enterprise value: HK\$73.5bn / \$9.4bn	EBITDA (Rmb mn)	(894.0)	(746.1)	1,237.6	3,250.7
3m ADTV: HK\$1.2bn / \$156.2mn	EPS (Rmb)	(5.31)	(0.59)	5.00	12.39
China	P/E (X)	NM	NM	53.3	21.5
Greater China Technology	P/B (X)	NM	16.0	12.5	7.9
M&A Rank: 3	Dividend yield (%)	NM	0.0	0.0	0.0
Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: Yes	N debt/EBITDA (ex lease,X)	–	–	(1.1)	(0.9)
	CROCI (%)	(38.8)	(0.8)	30.4	55.4
	FCF yield (%)	–	(1.0)	(0.3)	2.5
		6/26	12/26E	6/27E	12/27E
	EPS (Rmb)	0.43	(1.02)	1.34	3.66

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 11 Sep 2026 close.

Disclosure Appendix

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Target price history table(s) Iluvatar (9903.HK)

Date of report	Target price (HK\$)	Closing price (HK\$)
13-Sep-26	859.00	311.60
19-Jul-26	1,000.00	495.20

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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